

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms of feeling sad for as long as he can remember , difficulty making decisions , hopelessness , worsening suicidal ideations , guilt from past problems , and lack of energy and concentration over the past 2 weeks suggest a depressive disorder . The patient's belief that he is cursed and that bad things will happen to him if he expects them to , is a cognitive distortion that is common in depression . The patient's ability to hold a job suggests that his symptoms are not severe enough to be classified as severe depression . However , the presence of worsening suicidal ideations and hopelessness indicates that the patient is at risk for double depression , which is a condition where a person experiences depression and a more severe episode of depression in the future . </think><answer> A . The patient is at risk for double depression . </answer>

